PRODUCT PLANNING & MARKET ANALYSIS DIVISION

IBM

MEETING OR CONTACT REPORT

70-6076-0

Project: STRETCH	Date of Report: 6/15/56
Purpose of Meeting or Contact: Next Generation of Machines	Date of Meeting or Contact: 6/15/56
	Reported by: J. E. Griffith
	Dept.: Machine Planning
Place of Meeting or Contact: ☐ WHQ ☐ Phone Other: Poughkeepsie	Follow-up Date:

List Personnel Participating
Give Report (including next action)
Indicate Distribution

Attendance

Mr. C. J. Bashe	Mr. J. E. Griffith
Dr. J. A. Blaauw	Mr. J. A. Haddad
Dr. W. Buchholz	Dr. C. C. Hurd
Mr. J. M. Coombs	Mr. W. J. Lawless
Mr. S. W. Dunwell	Mr. D. W. Pendery
Mr. P. Fagg	Mr. R. A. Rahenkamp
Mr. R. A. Gregory	Mr. N. Rochester

The meeting was called by Mr. J. A. Haddad with an invitation to Dr. C. C. Hurd to state his views on the next generation of computers (STRETCH).

Dr. Hurd then stated the following opinions:

1. Flexible I/O is needed to eliminate compatability problems.

2. Customers are more sophisticated now.

3. MPD will probably not accept a decimal machine because of the binary nature of their input-output.

4. That education of the customers should be possible, especially in view of number 2.

5. Both customers and CES have need of extensive built-in checking.

6. MPD must have checking in order to guarantee performance specifications.

7. Customers are probably willing to pay more for a checked machine.

8. The STRETCH proposal looks adequate with regard to generalized I/O equipment.

9. The binary-decimal controversy be settled by comparing problems.

Mr. Haddad then stated that, in his opinion, the binary-decimal question was largely academic; especially since present plans included flexible logic to satisfy both binary and decimal demands. He felt that the memory organization was more basic than the exact form of character representation, for instance.

Mr. S. W. Dunwell then wrote on the blackboard a list of STRETCH intentions as follows:

1. Use any code with I/O.

    a. Convert to useable code with mapping.

2. Memory addressing binary to facilitate mapping.

    a. For decimal tables, either

        1. Convert decimal to binary
        2. Waste some space
        3. Build in conversion hardware

3. LINK computer will provide both base 2 and 10 arithmetic.

4. Instructions will be binary.

5. Fast arithmetic unit will be binary.

6. Logic will be handled in binary form.

7. Variable field and record size will be provided.

Elias multi-dimensional checking was discussed for the edification of Dr. Hurd, and the meeting ended at 2:15 p.m.

cc: Mr. J. W. Birkenstock
Mr. W. C. Gamrath
Mr. R. E. Kaufmann
Mr. W. W. Simmons
Mr. R. B. Smith
Mr. C. H. Wiley